PLACEMENT PREPARATION

Summer Placements – Product Management 2021 Edition



SIGMA - The Product Management & Technology Club

IIM BANGALORE

Contents

PRODUCT/PROGRAM MANAGEMENT 4

Microsoft 4

- **Shashwat Sinha** 5
- **Nirmal Kaarthick M** 6
- **Parthkumar Patel** 7
- **Krishna Kolapkar** 10
- **Rohit Kumar** 11
- **Jatan Vyas** 12
- **Venkateswaran M** 12
- **Ankit Surkar** 13

Cisco 14

- **Chelvapandi P** 15
- **Rajarshee Naskar** 16

EA 17

- **Manu Mitraan** 18

Google 19

- **Ishwari Tambakhe** 20
- **Aman Agarwal** 22
- **Jaya Dodeja** 23

United Health Group- Optum 25

- **Arjun K** 25
- **Nishant Singh** 26

Salesforce 27

- **Vaibhav Shah** 28

FinIQ 29

- **Pooja Pangavhane** 29

Samsung Research 30

- **Ankit Kishore** 31
- **Suresh** 31
- **Sahil Parmar** 32

Walmart Labs 33

- **Mansi Agrawal** 33

Piyush Trivedi 34
Info Edge 35
Akshat Singh 35
Senthil Kumar K 36
IBM 37
Manjot Singh 37
Goldman Sachs Marcus 38
Madhuri Vemulapty 38
Atlassian 39
Adithya M Ramesh 39
Corning 40
Adil Nazeer 40

PRODUCT/PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

Microsoft

Designation	**Program Manager Intern**
Job Description	As the in-house advocate for the millions of people worldwide who use Microsoft products, you drive the technical vision, design, implementation and market success of next-generation software solutions. As the CEO of your product components, some of the questions which you would be addressing through your role are: • What customer problem I am addressing? • What product solution do I craft to address this gap? • How do I deliver the best customer experience possible? • Does the product solution meet the business need (revenue, brand, etc.)? • How do I take the product from conceptualization to launch? • How do I work with marketing, and various sales channels to drive adoption?
Roles & Responsibilities	The role entails the following three distinct aspects: ***Defining and executing product strategy and roadmap***: Defining who the product is for, identifying the fundamental problem that we are solving, understanding the competition, and our core positioning with respect to the competition, identifying our approach to the market and partnerships. ***Building the Product:*** Lots of white boarding, storyboarding, sketching and designing, iterating with engineering on trade-offs between priority/timelines/capabilities, partnering across teams in Microsoft to deliver the solution, performing usability studies, planning versions, legal, marketing, monetization plans etc. ***Connecting with the customer:*** Evangelizing product through customer connect, being the 'face' of the product, experimentation and data analysis, iterating on feedback and learnings.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Group Activity + Interview

Experiences

Shashwat Sinha

Workex: 36 months, Software Developer, Oracle
Education Background: B.Tech in Electronics Engineering from IIT(BHU), Varanasi

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
There were no restrictions as such but relevant workex is definitely an added advantage.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
GD (25 minutes)
It is essentially a product design round which is termed as GD.

Problem - To make learning/teaching experience more enjoyable and productive for students. We were supposed to come up with a new product or improve an existing product. I chose the latter and worked on improving Microsoft Teams. We were given 20 minutes to create a doc and discuss with an interviewer 1 on 1 for about 5 minutes explaining your thinking and solution. We had to submit the word doc finally.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
Based on the GD submissions, students were shortlisted for the interviews.

Interview Round 1 (40 mins)
Metric Change Question: You are the PM at Uber. One morning you go into your office and see that monthly rides are down in August. Explore reasons and what next will you do?
Apart from the traditional approach we use for solving such questions (doing MECE), interviewer was much more interested in knowing how will you approach the situation from different angles. He was analyzing your structured thinking at every step and helping out.
He also asked what will you do as a developer to alert the team earlier instead of seeing the effect from metric.

Interview Round 2 (25 mins)
Favorite product and improvements. Why PM? Tech interests and discussion on that?
Use this to showcase your interest by asking questions and even his thoughts on recent developments in the tech world

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/guesstimates etc.
The questions were mostly tech based and a bit of HR questions why PM types. Guesstimates were not asked in Microsoft interview .

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?
I used the following books to prepare: -

- Decode and Conquer

- Cracking the PM Interview
- ProdMan Book IIM A
- ProdMan Book Sigma

Apart from these, Exponent Youtube videos are a must watch. They give a good flavor of the interview and try first to solve questions by yourself and then see how the interviewee is solving the question.
For tech related happenings, verge, techcrunch are good websites.
For Microsoft specifically just brush up on their existing products and latest launches.

6. General tips/suggestions?

- Try to be find 1-2 people who are as interested as you for PM roles and do PM cases with them. Choose a domain such as food delivery and analyze the products relevant to that such as Swiggy, Zomato. Analyzing diff apps from a PM lens helps a long way in your prep.
- As the D-day comes, it is very important to be calm and confident during the interview. Campus placements never define your life and treat them only as a part of your 2 year journey.
- Next for someone interested in PM, please do not fall into the peer pressure and herd mentality trap and change your tracks. If you have prepared well for PM(especially for people with relevant work-ex), there is a very high chance that you will get into a good PM role with the opportunities you have at campus.

Nirmal Kaarthick M

Workex: 4 Years, (3 years in Sales, 1 year in Consulting)
Education Background: B.Tech Mechatronics, SASTRA University

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

No restrictions whatsoever. In the conventional shortlist, most people shortlisted were from tech background.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

I got shortlisted via PM Engage (Microsoft's case competition). All campus finalists are given a mentor with whom you engage over 3-4 calls, solving cases and doing mock interviews. Unfortunately, in my case we didn't get to mock interview due to time constraints. But I was directly hotlisted for the final interviews bypassing the technical GD round – which essentially is the same as the case comp (product design).

3. Interview rounds and their details?

Had 2 rounds of interviews, back to back each lasting for roughly 15-20 mins. First round was product design, second round was around resume and HR questions.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/ technical/ resume/ based/ cases/ guesstimates etc.

First round question – How would you design a smart coffee machine offered by Microsoft? Went through typical CIRCLES method. Came up with use cases where such a device would be of use. Talked about including it MS ecosystem instead of being a standalone product which will help boost sales as well. Lots of cross questioning and challenging of your ideas, but need to remain calm, take in constructive feedback and proceed accordingly.

Second round – What is PM? Why are you interested in PM? What did you do in your previous work ex related to PM? What MS service do you use the most? Suggest an improvement / change for that (Talked about LinkedIn for blue collar workers with use cases and how to market it among target audience).
What recent technology development excites you? (Told about NFT and had follow up questions on what it is and why it is in news, vendors dealing with NFT).

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

Decode and Conquer, Sigma resources and IIMA PM Casebook, few YouTube videos for PM cases

6. General tips/suggestions?

If you are a non-techie (even otherwise), do participate in case comps as the performance their will help you in shortlists and interviews. Definitely that's the case with Microsoft. During the interviews, ask questions and keep it interactive. Think out loud and don't make any assumptions. Start looking at apps that you use daily from a critical point of view – how it can be improved, why is it designed in that particular way.

Parthkumar Patel

Workex: 11 Months, Software Engineer, Traum Ferienwohnungen, Germany (OYO Rooms)
Education Background: B.Tech. (Information and Communication Technology), Dhirubhai Ambani Institute of Information and Communication Technology, Gandhinagar

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

There were no such work experience criteria. I, myself having less than 12 months of work ex got the shortlist. Also, there are no such criteria for the domain of work ex but work ex or educational background in the software domain certainly helps.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Execution, Metrics, Behavioural, App Critique

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

Yes, so there is a GD round before the interviews. Don't worry, this is not a typical GD round that most of us are scared of. (alteast it used to scare me off). It's kind of a product design round only and needs to be done individually. In the common teams call, there will be an announcement of the topic and then you will be sent to different breakout rooms and you will be given 20 mins to write your product design document. At the end of the 20 mins, you need to explain your approach to your moderator who will either be there throughout the call or jumping between different breakout rooms. You also need to submit the word document you

prepared. Based on your submission and your explanation to the moderator shortlist for the interviews will be given.

One tip from my side to crack this round - Try to cover each and every head under the CIRCLES framework. Since the given time is 20 mins, do not spend much time on any one head. There will be cross-questioning on the assumptions you made (Like for my solution I assumed that the product will be first launched in the US so they asked why US?) or the solution you provided so do not throw any jargon without having knowledge about it.

The topic for the GD: Design a new app or add functionality to any of the existing Microsoft apps to make learning and/or teaching more enjoyable and productive for students and/or teachers.

3. Interview rounds and their details?

There were 2 rounds in total for me.

1st Round: Taken by Senior Product Manager - Middle Aged

- Asked about what I believe is the product manager's job. I explained it using my own experience as a head of product development during my own start-up in my UG. Also, connected it to my work-ex where also I got the opportunity to handle the E2E feature launch. So always try to connect back these types of questions to real-life experiences of yours. It establishes the credibility that you are not talking out of thin air that you have empathy, you love to solve customer pain points, etc. but you have real experiences (be it from your work ex or your UG projects or your own start-up) to back it up.
- After knowing that I had my own start-up in my final year he asked me to explain it. Be thorough with all the nitty-gritty of the venture - the product design, value propositions, GTM strategy, success metrics, revenue model, etc. For me, this only became a product design question. Cross-questioned a lot about a lot of things but it was a fun and healthy discussion instead of an interview.
- Asked about my favourite app, I explained why it is my favourite app using Utility, Innovativeness and Ease of Use Framework. There were a lot of cross-questions, situation-based questions and depth in the discussion. So whatever you choose, be very thorough with the research of the app. Also, know about the industry that your favourite app is in. A lot of questions about how the industry is doing and the industry's future. So research about the competitors and industry in general as well. You will be asked about improvements, what do you not like about the app/want to remove.

2nd Round:

- Started with 'introduce yourself' and asked about why PM & why Microsoft initially.
- Then moved on to the question of "Favourite Microsoft product". Again, I explained the features of the app and why I like it. Asked about the improvements and a lot of situational questions based on that. The interviewer was not quite responsive in this round, so it was essential to maintain your composure & confidence and be structured in whatever you answer.
- Asked if I had any questions for him. Never miss this shot to show your interest in the company. Always prepare a question upfront before the interview. Ask about something strategic in nature that has been launched in the recent past and also impacts India. I asked about Azure Farmbeats and how Indian Agritech startups are leveraging Farmbeats in the

Indian context currently. The interviewer didn't work on this product, so didn't have any knowledge, but he promised me to get back on this.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/guesstimates etc.

Favourite app, Product design, Product improvement, situational questions.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

- Resources I used were SIGMA prep book (must), past year experiences (just like you are reading this one, trust me it is definitely useful) and IIM-A PM Book (must). Read Divide and Conquer for basics (only if you have time)
- Good Youtube channels are exponent, The product folks, PM School, etc.
- Solve a few free cases from https://www.productmanagementexercises.com Use your case group and seniors as your resources too

Specific to company preparation:

- Prepare about why PM? Why Microsoft?
- Research about all the Microsoft products. They can ask about improving any Microsoft Product.
- Be definitely ready with one Microsoft and one non-Microsoft favourite app with thorough research.
- Prepare product design questions on the apps designed for kids like a search engine for kids, credit card for kids, etc.
- Prepare a well-researched question to ask at the end of the interview.

6. General tips/suggestions?

Do a lot of product cases with your friends or like-minded people who are interested in PM prep. I used to do the same and with every case done I used to learn something new. Be thorough with the frameworks like CIRCLES for product design. Be ready with multiple favourite apps with proper research. Suppose you are going for a Microsoft interview then prepare one Microsoft and one non-Microsoft app.

Also, be ready with critiques of apps from each and every sector like fintech, ed-tech, food, healthcare, ride-hailing, etc. Concepts like Network effects, Economies of Scale, etc and technologies like ML, AR/VR, Blockchain, Cloud should be well understood and use them whenever you can while giving the solutions to a product design question. Be prepared with your resume because product design questions can also be asked for the organisations you already worked for.

Metrics are a very important part of any product design question. I suggest not to use any framework here but instead make your custom metrics based on the question. Good metrics suggested will fetch you brownie points. Overall, be structured in your approach.

Be in contact with your seniors and try to do some mock interviews with them as well. (Trust me they are the best resource that you can have at IIM B)

In the end, keep smiling throughout the interview (It's a tried and tested strategy, fetched me 2 companies)

Krishna Kolapkar

Workex: 45 Month, Senior Software Engineer @Rakuten
Education Background: Electronics Engineer, Veermata Jijabai Technological Institute (VJTI)

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
No, everyone could apply.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
GD – They basically give you a case (e.g., product design question) over a zoom call. You must write a solution and submit a word doc in 30 mins. That will be followed by breakout room one on one discussion with a PM in Microsoft. Candidates are shortlisted for the interview round based on their performance in the GD round. Top performers are given hotlist and even the order of the interview is determined based on your GD performance.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
2 Rounds
1. General work experience and background questions followed by a case
   a) Tell me about yourself
   b) What were your responsibilities at your previous company?
   c) Why PM?
   d) Why Microsoft
   e) As I had worked in an ecommerce company, I was asked to design dashboard for merchants on Flipkart and was asked to explain success metric for such a platform. Then had a brief discussion about how the platform will be used by the merchants, use cases etc.

   Note: Very friendly interviewer, felt more like an interaction and a brainstorming session
2. Second round was bit intense, interviewer looked unimpressed throughout the interview. I was asked to work on the same dashboard and discuss on how it will be used by the CXOs of the company, again use cases. Success Metrics and tradeoffs.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/ technical/ resume based/ cases/ guesstimates etc.
Work Experience and Case

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation.
Material shared by placecomm, online practice examples, tryexponent.com, PMSchool, Prodman.com

6. General tips/suggestions?

Practice lot of cases with peers, Read about PM role, study frameworks, develop your own frameworks, follow tech news, read about the company extensively, make notes, be creative with your answers, and most importantly, stay confident and calm throughout the interview.

Rohit Kumar

Workex: 3 years
Education Background: B. Tech ECE

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

There was not any restrictions, but majority of the intake were with workex.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

There was technical GD as a pre-process. Candidates were given a short case and 20 minutes as a timeframe. Since, last year it was online process, so it was not a GD kind of thing but rather an individual submission.

3. Interview rounds and their details?

There were two interview rounds. First was purely technical, second was mix of technical as well as some managerial questions.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/ technical/ resume based/ cases/ guesstimates etc.

The interview started from the introduction and then it moved on to the resume. I thinks, it depends on interviewee as well on how he/she is driving through the answers. Initially, it was more of resume based. Later, case was asked. One advice would be to be familiar with the recent happenings around the world and your resume as well. Cases might be from any of these. In the second round, it started with a short case. After that some HR questions were asked.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation.

Sigma Resource, IIMA casebook, Decode and Conqueror, some product management YouTube channel. I would also recommend going through some of the consulting cases as it provides a structure to deal with some specific scenarios.

6. General tips/suggestions?

- Do not assume anything, ask even if it is a smaller thing.
- While solving the cases, keep interviewer aware of what you are thinking.
- Always write it down somewhere your recommendations. There might be 10+ recommendations and they may ask you to prioritize it.

- Be thorough with the frameworks.

Jatan Vyas

Workex: 2.5 years, Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL)
Education Background: B.Tech (ECE), SVNIT-Surat

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
Not required

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
Microsoft PM Engage was a case competition held, gave campus round finalists a PPI. GD held for others.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
Two rounds of interview: One with manager level, another with a senior executive.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/ technical/ resume based/ cases/ guesstimates etc.
Questions started with resume based, where there was discussion on workex and past PORs' learnings. Interview soon moved to PM case – new product as well as favorite MS product. Interview ended with HR type questions. Format was similar for both interviews.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation.
Apart from the common resources shared by Sigma, be prepared with company specific latest information: what their key focus area is, what products and features are in pipeline, etc.

6. General tips/suggestions?
Stay curious and show your tech enthusiasm in the interview! Be very thorough with your most favorite and least favorite MS products, and how they can be further improved. Develop the case approach with practice but stay flexible – structures are good to have but need not always be used. Try to come up with creative solutions and approaches to the problems.

Venkateswaran M

Workex: 12 months, Accolite Digital India Private limited
Education Background: CSE, College of Engineering Guindy

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**
Not to my knowledge

PM Topics Covered: Product Design

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
In this round all candidates were asked to design an application for a smart classroom.

We were put into separate breakout rooms and were given half an hour to come up with a solution.
I used the circles method to design the solution. The panelist entered my room at the end of the stipulated time and asked me a few questions and then wished me luck for the next round

3. Interview rounds and their details?

Round 1

- The interviewer started off by asking me to introduce myself
- The interviewer briefly introduced himself and then dove straight into a product case
- The question was: Design a risk management system for any e commerce company like amazon
- (My previous workex was in a bank where I had worked at risk - a different type of risk though)
- I looked at the problem from perspectives of sellers and buyers
- For sellers I identified potential problems like buyers returning goods other than what they had bought, problems with delivery like damage and fraud etc
- For buyers I looked at the trustworthiness of sellers, the quality of the product being sold etc
- The interviewer asked a few follow up questions and then wished me best of luck for the next round

Round 2

- This was a relatively short round. The interviewer asked me to come up with an analytics dashboard for an e-commerce site
- I started off by listing all possible requirements of sellers like the prices of similar products, metrics about the popularity of the products, delivery times and so on
- The interviewer asked a few follow up questions and ended the interview

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/guesstimates etc.

I did standard case prep and I practiced a few product cases for PM roles

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

Resources provided by the placecom. And I went through the company's website for Microsoft specific prep

Ankit Surkar

Workex: 3 years
Education Background: B. Tech. CSE, MIT Pune

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

No workex restrictions were there.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

I was a part of Microsoft PM Engage competition and so I was exempted from the GD round.

3. Interview rounds and their details?

There was one interview but can say divided in two rounds. It went on for about 35 mins. The first interviewer wanted me to find out ways to drill down on to possible problems from a broader problem. The problem he gave me was – If you are working for some Rides share company and your senior comes to you with a screenshot that yesterday there were 20% less bookings in Pune. How will you analyse the problem?

The second interviewer wanted me to design a dashboard for suppliers of Amazon. He wanted me to think upon what will be the different metrics that I will put on the dashboard.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/ technical/ resume based/ cases/ guesstimates etc.

It was mostly a technical interview.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

It was mostly from the material provided by Sigma team, some interviews on Youtube from the channel – Exponent and a great help was https://tryexponent.com. Company specific preparation was not asked to me atleast.

Cisco

Designation	**Product Manager**
Job Description	As Product Manager at CISCO ENTERPRISE NETWORKING, you will be the virtual CEO of your product line and have full P&L accountability over the success of your portfolio. You will own all aspects of the product, including revenue, gross margin, customer growth, product vision, product roadmap and strategic initiatives. You will drive product line strategy, innovation and evolution to build a best-in-class offering. Your objective is to profitably grow the product at targeted rates. Your performance will be visible at the highest levels of the company, including the Business Unit General Managers and the EVP CISCO ENTERPRISE NETWORKING. This position offers the unique opportunity to lead the strategy, innovation and evolution of a key CISCO ENTERPRISE NETWORKING product line.

Roles & Responsibilities	In your role as a Product Manager, you will work across functional teams to create and execute your vision for the product, routinely collaborating with and influencing colleagues in Product Development, Engineering, Marketing and Sales.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Group Activity + Interview

Experiences

Chelvapandi P

Workex: 34 Months, Infosys Ltd.
Education Background: B.E(ECE), MNMJEC, 2014-2018

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
There were no restrictions on the number of months of work experience, but some work-ex was required.

PM Topics Covered: Product Execution, Behavioural, System Design

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
Resume Shortlisting and GD. The GD topic was 'Can AI replace humans?'. It was a conventional group discussion (2 mins for preparation+ 15 mins for discussion).

3. Interview rounds and their details?
Round 1: Technical and Situational questions
- Basic introduction followed by details on work done during past work experience
- Questions structured around why the interest to be a Product Manager? and why Cisco?
- Questions based on my technical role in work experience
- Resume point mentioned about leading the application support team – questions about the major issue I've encountered and the step-by-step approach I followed to resolve the incident.
- Questions on applying digital solutions to legacy systems in banking domain as my workex was in banking sector
- Questions on Scrum framework and how it helps streamline project management.
- Situational questions – the questions were mostly centered around situations that I had encountered in the past (E.g., Conflict in the team, high pressure situation, going the extra mile, learning opportunities etc.) and how I acted upon them.

Round 2: HR
- Introduction
- Reasons for switching from a technical role to a managerial role
- Why do you want to join Cisco and what do you bring to the table?
- What is your expectation from the 2-month summer internship process at Cisco?
- Questions on my preference about relocation

- Generic questions like what makes you stand out from the other candidates, strength & weakness

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/ technical/ resume based/ cases/ guesstimates etc.

Most of the questions were around my technical role in my past workex and the points I had furnished in my resume. The structure of the interview is to mostly judge your managerial capabilities in difficult situations that might arise in an actual scenario.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

- Sigma Prep book
- Cracking the PM Interview
- Decode and conquer – case prep
- Exponent YouTube channel
- www.productmanagementexercises.com

6. General tips/suggestions?

Be thorough with every point mentioned in the resume as most of the interviews were centered around the workex and POR sections of the resume. Be authentic in the instances you point from your professional/personal life for the situational questions. Frame all your answers using the STAR method as it helps structure your answer in a better way.

Rajarshee Naskar

Workex: 26 months; Industry: IT

Education Background: B.Tech (Electronics & Communication Engineering)

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Yes; Work ex required (As per JD shared by Placement Committee). No specific work ex cap mentioned

PM Topics Covered: App Critique, Product Design, Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

On GD day the shortlisted candidates were divided into groups. Each person had to choose a number which had a topic. We had 30 seconds to think and then speak for a minute. The topics were not related to technology; it was any random topic, for example, environment.

3. Interview rounds and their details?

Panel of 2 interviewers. Duration- About 30-40 minutes

- Started the interview by asking about favourite app (Told the prepared answer).
- Follow up questions: How will you expand the reach of the app, what are the problems you face while using the app, how will you address these issues, described a specific requirement, and asked the metrics to check the performance of the app.
- Next, the interviewers asked about workex. Elaborated the previous job role. No technical stuff asked. Tell me a situation where you faced a challenging situation in your job. Since

my role involved interaction with client team, I was asked follow-up questions on the situation and some more hypothetical questions. What was your contribution in resolving the issue in the situation that I described?
- What all technical skills did you implement in workex? What programming languages do you know? Please note that there were no follow-up questions on these.
- Next, why do you want to be in Product Management? Many follow up questions in this part. Why not Consulting/Marketing? Lastly, any questions for the interviewer?
- HR interaction. Duration- About 10 minutes, What do you know about Cisco? What Cisco products do you know about? Why ProdMan? Your preferable place of internship if it's offline? Any questions for the HR?
- PS: Please download Cisco Webex Meetings beforehand

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/guesstimates etc.

Favourite App question was followed up with different cases like geographical expansion, metrics, as described above. For HR, have a basic knowledge about the company, products, history, etc. Nothing directly asked from Resume, but good to have a decent knowledge about what you write in Resume. I described many resume points in my answers.
No Guesstimates/Technical

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

- IIM Ahmedabad ProdMan material, Cracking the PM interview, Tech blogs (Techno Managers).
- For HR questions, had an overview of the company and its products from Wiki. JD should be referred for role.

6. General tips/suggestions?

- Please prepare basic questions like improving commonly used apps/your favourite app questions beforehand.
- Always try to frame your answers from what learning you have experienced before. Have a structured way while answering. This works very well.
- For PM, try to bring in recent happenings (if possible) in tech products and give examples.

EA

Designation	**Product Manager**
Job Description	The Product Manager rolls into the Product Management function within EA and is a key element of the Game Atomic Unit - the core unit that builds the game. Building games involves a healthy balance between Art & Science and the Product Analyst is able to assimilate huge volumes of data captured from the players and translate it into meaningful insights to the team.

Roles & Responsibilities	• Utilize relevant product and industry knowledge to evaluate latest technology solutions (SDK's)while serving as a strong cross functional leader • Leverage techno functional expertise to work with other Product Managers across game titles and improve the effectiveness of our telemetry, game analytics platform and quality of automated reporting. • Execute projects and optimize workflows involving quantitative analysis & research while driving strategy towards long term vision • Uncover data trends to gain player insights on new & existing products • Work with multiple teams across EA offices and take ownership on projects as required • Ability to work both as an individual contributor and a team player while working actively with cross functional teams on strategies for executing, measuring impact, communicating results, and automation • Strong critical thinking, analytical bent of mind and exceptional problem solving skills • Gaming or Web start-up environment and Product perspective a big plus • Experience with BI, data mining & visualization tools (Microstrategy, Tableau, R, Teradata, MySQL, HiveQL etc.) and statistical software (SPSS, SAS, R) and Hadoop a plus • Passion for gaming and understanding of freemium mechanics in social and mobile games • Extremely Accountable, ability to multitask and work in a dynamic environment • Background in statistics, software engineering, database administration or other quantitative disciplines is highly valued • Excellent written and verbal communication skills
Process	Resume shortlisting + Case Submission + Interview

Experiences

Manu Mitraan

Workex: 2 years

Education Background: Computer Science and Engineering, IITD

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Yes. 1 – 5 years. Preferred background: Any experience with Gaming, Media & Entertainment industry

PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy, Product Design, App Critique, Metrics, Guesstimates

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

Yes, Case submission.

Design 1 detailed in-product features for the game chosen, wherein the feature is specifically targeted to increase come up with in-game (no co-branding, product placement etc.) feature

or mechanic that either moves DAU or Revenue to the tune of 10-15%. You should deep dive into the feature idea with specific flows and back up the revenue upside through number-based funnel calculations.

3. Interview rounds and their details?

There were two rounds. But it was long and had cases as well as HR questions
HR questions:

- Walk through you resume.
- State 2 of your biggest achievements.
- Why Product Management?

Case related questions:

- What is your favorite game? Why?
- Design a feature for the game which increases revenue by around 10%.
- What is the GTM strategy for the feature?
- What are the metrics to follow through after implementing the feature?

Guesstimate: Annual revenue of the game company from all sources.

Round 2: Case question

- What is your favorite mobile app?
- Design a feature to increase its revenue or DAU by 10%
- How will user retention be affected by the feature?

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/guesstimates etc.

Most of the questions were based on the case for both the rounds. Resume based questions (HR) were focused on the start of the interview as an icebreaker.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

Prepared from the material shared by sigma. Went through 'Cracking the PM Interview' and 'Decode and Conquer'. I had a general idea of what the company does, but I was not asked any questions specific to the company.

6. General tips/suggestions?

Learn about favorite apps/ games

Google

Designation	**Product Manager**
Job Description	One of the many reasons Google consistently brings innovative, world-changing products to market is because of the collaborative work we do in Product Management. As a Product Manager, you'll work closely with our engineers to guide products from conception to launch. You'll bridge

	the technical and business worlds as you design services that our customers love, working with teams across Google such as Engineering, Design, Sales, Marketing, and Finance. You'll be responsible for guiding products throughout the execution cycle, focusing specifically on analyzing, positioning, packaging, promoting, and tailoring our solutions to all the markets where Google does business. With eyes focused squarely on the future, you'll work closely with creative and prolific engineers to help design and develop technologies that improve access to the world's information. You'll have a bias toward action and can break down complex problems into steps that drive product development at Google speed and scale.
Roles & Responsibilities	● Build and manage a product roadmap to support our goals and strategies. ● Create preliminary design concepts, and work with engineering to implement and iterate them. ● Initiate and prioritize projects within engineering, assist in determining the best technical implementation methods, track product development and develop product launch plans. ● Develop the product strategy, go-to-market plans, positioning, messaging and all elements related to the business case.
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview

Experiences

Ishwari Tambakhe

Workex: 46 Months at Norton Antivirus
Education Background: B.Tech. in Computer Engineering from VIT, Pune

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary? –
NA

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, App Critique, Root Cause Analysis

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
GD: Time: 20 mins
Following two topics were given and group had to choose one by mutual consensus:
1. Is India ready for Cashless Economy?
2. Feasibility of Electric Vehicles in India

3. Interview rounds and their details?
Round 1:
Focus Area: Product Design and Strategic Insight
Time: 45 mins
Question:

- Design an app for Carrot Farmers (Entire discussion revolved around different user groups, their pain points, and the solutions to those pain points)

Round 2:
Focus Area: Technical + Analytical
Time: 45 mins
Questions:

- Suppose YouTube video is in buffering state for a very long time. What could be the reasons?
- How will you diagnose what the actual problem is for all the stated reasons?
- Optimize battery life of Google Pixel mobile phone so that it runs for 2 days
- How much impact does the Camera app has on Battery consumption? (Follow-up question based on the answer to previous question)
- Design a system for scheduled email in Gmail
- Suppose you realize that Scheduling algorithm had a bug and you missed sending scheduled mails for the last 24 hours. How will you handle this situation? Will you handle the oldest mails first or the latest ones which are due for sending?
- How will you store timestamp in a Database?
- How will you store password in a Database? Explain encryption in layman's terms

Round 3:
Focus Area: Role Related Knowledge + General Cognitive Ability + Googleyness & Leadership
Time: 45 mins
Questions:

- Suppose you are a PM at Spotify. How will you recommend a playlist to the user based on a single song he/she has listened to?
- Measure the success of the recommended playlist
- Suppose user is not liking the recommended playlist, what songs will you recommend?
- Suppose FedEx wants to start delivering their parcels using Drones and want to begin with a Pilot project. Calculate the no of Drones required for such delivery in Mumbai in a single day.
- How will you measure the effectiveness of the drone delivery?
- General views on the drone delivery feasibility
- Toughest challenge you have faced at work

Round 4:
Focus Area: Googleyness and Leadership
Time: 20 mins
Questions:

- How did you help the peer who wasn't performing up to the mark. What you would have done differently as a manager?
- How did you handle the situation when your suggestion or idea wasn't accepted in the product? Did this rejection impact your relationship with your manager?

- As a PM, you will get many product ideas from many team members. How will you convey rejections to some of them and still make sure they don't feel discouraged to give ideas in future?
- What all factors you will consider before designing any product so that it caters to the needs of all the prospective users? (e.g. Blind, Differently abled, etc)

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**
   - Details added in the previous answer

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**
   - Books: Cracking the PM Interview & Decode and Conquer
   - Websites: https://stellarpeers.com/, https://www.productmanagementexercises.com/
   - Brush-up of Technical concepts in Computer Science

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

Having patience and courage till 4th day of the Placement Process and giving your best when the opportunity comes up!!!

Aman Agarwal

Workex: 36 months, Oracle India Pvt. Ltd
Education Background: B-Tech., Computer Science and Engineering, IIIT Jabalpur

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

No

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioural, System Design

2. **Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?**

Group Discussion was conducted right before the interviews on the same day.

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

Round 1: Group Discussion
Duration: 20 minutes

Round 2: Technical + Analytical Interview

- Question 1 – System Design for an application.
  Focus on UI and Backend. Asked me to walk through different screens of the app, the features and how will information be represented on each screen. For backend, I was asked how the different routines will look like (API calls), the database structure, and the tech stack.
- Question 2 – Success Metrics for an application.
  I followed the AAREM framework, and the interviewer was satisfied with my answer.

Round 3: Product Design + Strategic Insight Interview

- Asked to pick a non-technical, non-digital product. The first thing that caught my sight was a water bottle. Yes, I chose to go ahead with this product in the interview of this magnitude and spent the 45 minutes of my life discussing why I liked the water bottle that I was using and why it was the most important thing in anyone's life. Apologies, writing this interview experience got too boring too fast!
- The discussion revolved around what features I would like to add to the bottle I was using, which feature I would prioritize and why. I was also asked about the ethical implications (if any) of my choices. I kept all my arguments customer centric and based all my reasoning on the goal to improve customer experience. The interviewer posed multiple scenarios and challenged my stance and even asked me what I would do if my propositions could not possibly be implemented.

Round 4: Strategic Insight + Analytical + Technical
This was supposed to be a mixture of Google Values, Knowledge about the Role, and Cognitive Abilities but the interviewer had different plans for me.
Question 1 – Product Strategy
Question 2 – Guesstimate
Question 3 – System Design

Round 5 – Scenario based HR questions

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

A mix of technical, guesstimate, and HR questions

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

IIMA ProdMan Case Book

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

Prepare System Design and Success Metrics well. Whenever in doubt, keep your customer at the center and then answer.

Jaya Dodeja

Workex: 3 years at Adobe
Education Background: Computer Science and Engineering, BIT Mesra

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

Apparently candidates with greater than or equal to 3 years of work ex with a Computer Science/IT background were shortlisted.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, App Critique, Metrics, Root Cause Analysis, Behavioural, Guesstimates

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

GD on the day of the interview. All 18 shortlisted candidates had a common GD. The topic was "Is India ready for a cashless economy".

3. Interview rounds and their details?

There were 3 rounds of 45 mins each all scheduled on the same day.

Interview Round 1

It was scheduled with a Product Manager working at the Sydney office. We exchanged introductions in the beginning. He asked me three broad questions.

- Behavioural questions around conflict management
- Root Cause Analysis Case : A website is down for few users, find out why.

Here, I started with clarifying questions by asking users in which geography faced this issue for how long. Then I split reasons into internal and external, eliminating the external reasons post discussion with the interviewer. I analysed the internal reasons using a system design approach, where we discussed about how the load balancer or server could be causing an issue. It was an open-ended discussion.

- Guesstimate the number of bags arriving at any airport in a day. Here I assumed Delhi Airport and explained my approach as well as came up with a final answer.

Interview 2

It was scheduled with a Product Manager working at the Bangalore office. We exchanged introductions in the beginning. She first asked me about my favourite physical product (non-tech). Few follow up questions were:

- Why is the product your favourite? What benefits do you see?
- If you had to improve it, how would you?
- With the improved product, calculate the total addressable market. (Guesstimate)
- Design a GTM strategy for the new and improved product.
-

Interview 3

It was scheduled with a Product Manager working at the Bangalore office. We exchanged introductions in the beginning. It was the standard Googleyness round where they check if you're a good fit for Google's culture. Interview mostly revolved around behavioural questions:

- How have you handled conflicts in a leadership position in the past?
- Suppose you're a PM at Google, and you want to delay the launch of your product while the other leaders feel that the product should be launched with incomplete features, how would you convince them? A lot of follow-ups on this question. He was trying to judge my negotiation skills here and upto what point I will try to convince the team.
- Discussion about my past work experience, and why I wanted to become a PM and why at Google. Why didn't I become a PM at Adobe?

- Which PM resources do you follow?
- As a PM how would you bring an idea to the table? What if your engineering team hates it?

United Health Group- Optum

Designation	Product Intern
Job Description	This position would give the selected individual an opportunity to work on a live customer project in the healthcare space. The selected individual would be the part of a team that is involved in defining a solution and executing the same for one of our key stakeholders. • Work with the business to identify, analyze, document the business, recommending business priorities, and advising business on options, risks, and solutions. • Data analysis understand, interpret, validate, manipulate data using excel and other tools, and present conclusions and recommendations. • Qualitative analysis using business management concepts and strategy definition.
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview

Experiences

Arjun K

Workex: 35 months, Oracle, Senior Applications Engineer
Education Background: B Tech, Computer Science & Engineering

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
No, work ex wasn't mandatory for applying. Although my interview revolved around previous experience.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
No, interviews were held directly after resume shortlisting.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
There were 3 rounds of interviews – 2 technical and 1 HR. That being said, they were continually evaluating the fitness in the organization. The first round focused mostly on the profile and work experience. In the second round, a case was introduced for analysis.

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

Round 1:

This round was entirely about the candidate profile: walking through the profile, details on work experience, why an MBA, why Optum, what interesting would the candidate bring to the table, and extracurriculars.

Round 2:
In this round, the candidate was asked to introduce an app for taking pharmaceutical postal orders. The end-to-end process of conceptualization was asked and questioned. The candidate stuck to CIRCLES method to answer them. This round continued for around 30 minutes before the panel was satisfied.

Round 3:
In the final round, the candidate's expectations from the role were analyzed. Learnings from previous work was questioned.

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

Going through 'Cracking the PM Interview' and 'The PM Process' helped significantly in the preparation. Doing consulting cases as well helped understand the flavor of different industries, which came in handy during the interview. Also, being aware of the company and the profile being offered was really helpful. UHG questioned the candidate about various product lines that they are into.

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

Be prepared with basic frameworks to add structure to the answer when asked to develop apps/feature. Reading up on the company and the kind of roles they provide could help a lot.

Nishant Singh

Workex: 3.5 years
Education Background: B Tech. Mechanical Engineering, NIT Jamshedpur

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

No work ex restrictions as such but they prefer people with work ex.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, App Critique, Behavioural

2. **Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?**

No just resume shortlist and interview

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

One interview of around 50 minutes with multiple breakout rooms. I was sent to around 6 breakout rooms each with a different set of 2 to 3 panelists.

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

Questions were based on Product development which could have been answered using CIRCLES framework. They also asked about why product management, what is your expectation from the role, one application you use and the good and the bad things about it, how would you improve the bad things, what changes would you want in that app, how would it impact the user experience, few questions about technology in healthcare (was asked because I had an experience with a healthcare client in the past), selling a crop insurance to a farmer, problems with the Pharmeasy application, and my roles and responsibilities in the previous organization.

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything spexcific to the company preparation?**

Decode and Conquer, CIRCLES, HEART frameworks should be enough. This is a fortune 5 company and is really huge in USA in the Health tech domain so having some knowledge about their products will help in the interview.

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

Be calm and composed, don't beat around the bush, tell them upfront if you don't know something, product development-based questions need prior practice so that things are fed into your sub conscious and you don't panic and miss some important step while answering questions in the interview.

Salesforce

Designation	Associate Product Manager
Job Description	● Be part of a high-performance product management team that helps many fortune 500 companies delight their customers with their superior customer engagement ● Work with our industry experts to define the next business problem to solve that brings multiplier effect for our team ● Engage with customers, partners, and ISVs, along with product ambassadors from across Salesforce to prioritize the right features ● Own and drive the vision/strategy/roadmap/development for industry specific solutions ● Own our cross-industry product Point of View and directional roadmap including how it works with/leverages partner integrations. ● Work with PMs in other clouds like IoT, Einstein, etc to identify what we can leverage/extend/optimize for industries ● Work with our insanely talented engineering teams to get beautiful products developed ● Work with various stakeholders to ensure a successful launch of the product.

	● Represent Salesforce as a product expert at customer interactions, industry and corporate events, and through community sites and social media
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview

Experiences

Vaibhav Shah

Workex: 44 months
Education Background: B.E. (Hons) Computer Science

1. Were there any work-ex restrictions? Was relevant work-ex necessary?
Yes, there was a minimum work-ex restriction of 22 months and a maximum restriction of 62 months. Relevant work-experience in agile methodology and educational background was a bonus.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes, details of those?
There was a Group Discussion round. The GD was based around a product-improvement scenario – 'How would you improve Google Pay'. There were 6 participants in the GD. From the Salesforce side, there was a moderator and two other panel members who were there to judge the quality of the discussion points. We were given 1 minute to prepare and 10 minutes to discuss the topic.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
I did not have an interview. I was offered the role of APM based on my performance in the group discussion. In the group discussion I focused on applying the CIRCLES framework, identifying core gaps in the current app, and suggesting solutions for them.

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.
The group discussion was based around a typical product enhancement question.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?
For PM prep in general, I relied on a variety of sources.

- Books – Cracking the PM Interview, Decode and Conquer, IIMA ProdMan Guide and Sigma's the PM Process.
- Websites – Stellar Peers (Frameworks), Try Exponent (Product Questions), Product Management Exercises (Product Questions), The Verge (Tech News), CNET (Tech & Product News)
- Other - https://www.productplan.com/glossary/

6. General tips/suggestions?

Go through the Sigma's PM Process, IIMA ProdMan Guide and Decode & Conquer thoroughly. Practice PM case questions with a focus on new products, product enhancement and product metrics. One other suggestion is to create and maintain a document with core features and gaps of the top apps across multiple domains (social media, entertainment, food delivery, payment, fintech, edtech etc.). This will ensure that you can tackle any kind of product question without much difficulty.

FinIQ

Designation	Management Intern - Product Management
Job Description	Management Intern: We offer a multi-dimensional role which gives the interns equal exposure to Financial Markets, Business Management and Technology. Interns will be assigned to live projects and will be working on diverse roles and assignments in, • Pricing Mathematics for Financial Products • Product Management • Business Development
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview

Experiences

Pooja Pangavhane

Workex: 3 years in Eaton, New Product Development in Aerospace Industry
Education Background: Mechanical Engineer from COEP'18

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

No such criteria

PM Topics Covered: Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

Shortlist based on the CV and direct interview on day 0.

3. Interview rounds and their details?

2 Rounds.

- 1st round with 3 panelists Technical, puzzles and situational based.
- 2nd round with 2 panelists based on previous work ex, projects, situational and behavioral questions, values.

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

- Tell me about yourself and FinIQ. What sort of projects you have handled? Major achievement as a team? (Panelist will ask generic questions but you have to showcase your strengths and behavioral treats while answering)
- Mathematical puzzles- Just google general 5-6 puzzles to refresh the mind before interview.
- Resume based- Sports, research paper and UG project.

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

Read and understand the company portfolio. Get basic information about company culture and role. If you are trying for intern pricing strategy, brush up your FA basics and wealth managements.

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

- Be genuine and logical.
- My interview was more of conversation rather than question-answer session. Try to pull that. It will help in every interview.

Samsung Research

Designation	Product Management
Job Description	In the Product Management role in SRI-B, you will help design and implement our products, manage the end-to-end execution of product features, and contribute to product vision and strategy. Role & responsibilities will include (but are not limited to): - • Drive product vision and strategy in the team • Build product concept and be owner of all product requirements. • Build and Communicate product value proposition to end users, partners and other stakeholders • Analyze market, understand users/ personas • in the global as well as Indian context • Know the competitive landscape and be single voice on product direction. • Drive prioritization to enable team to focus and deliver most important features in a timely manner • Create product requirements and work with UX/Engineers for Interaction design for all features • Communicate with all internal stakeholders (Senior Management, Engineers, Business Teams …) • Define success metrics and analyze product performance
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview

Experiences

Ankit Kishore

Workex: 7 months, IT firm
Education Background: C.S.E., B.Tech

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
No restrictions on workex.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
Direct shortlist for interview.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
Just one round of interview, which lasts around 30 mins

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.
Most of the questions were around Technical from my undergrad projects, research papers and hackathons. HR questions mostly revolve around PORs and college extra-curricular activities. As my work-ex is a bit low, they mostly ask questions related my projects there.
Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation.
For company-specific preparation, I just went through all the slides that they provided before summer internship, and for overall preparation, I went through all the materials provided by the IIMB itself, including the book Decode and Conquer (one of my favorites)

5. General tips/suggestions?
Just follow all the materials given by the placement committee, and the suggestions provided by the seniors. Make your own small group of summer placement preparation with common area of interest, take part in most of GDs and try to meet as seniors as possible to get better preparation tips.

Suresh

Workex: 21 Months-Infosys (UI developer)
Education Background: B-Tech Mechanical

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
No Work ex restrictions, if you have Tech workex it will be helpful

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, App Critique

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
No GD was there

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

3 interview rounds (2 technical + 1 HR)

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

- They asked 2 cases (how can you increase the frequency of usage of SWIGGY app & improvements you would like to see on MYNTRA UI) and 1 guesstimate (estimate the market of 0k-30k mobiles in India) in round 1.
- In round 2 most of the questions were about my favourite app (increasing the engagement on cricbuzz during off season)

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

Sigma case booklet, Technomanagers blogspot, Divide & conquer book.

Sahil Parmar

Workex: 34 Months at Mahindra & Mahindra (Electric Vehicles)
Education Background: B.Tech. from IIT Delhi

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

No restriction
No such prerequisites

PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy

2. **Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?**

No GD. Direct shortlist and interview.

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

One round of interview taken by 2 of the Samsung employees.
Interview was pretty chill. It went on for about 30 minutes. Questions included –

- Tell me about yourself.
- Why this role?
- How would you fit in a technical role after manufacturing workex?
- My opinion on outlook of EV industry in India.
- Case based question: "How can EV application be used in delivery chain system?"
- Any question for us?

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

Resume Based, Case (1 case discussion that went on for about 20 min)

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

Sigma Prodman book. Nothing specific to company was asked.

6. General tips/suggestions?
Just be yourself. They don't expect you to know everything about company or even about the role. They, however, did expect you to apply your knowledge from your workex/projects to their needs. Practicing a few case solving would also help.

Walmart Labs

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Exhibit strong domain understanding and work closely with Business partners to create customer delight. • Execute on the product management problem statement by applying business knowledge and strong customer empathy. • Develops and champions a world class product vision and strategy for a product team managing multiple products. • Understand the strategy and execution of multiple projects in an Agile Environment for Product Management including product requirements. • Ensures alignment of product vision, strategy, and status with the executive leadership team's priorities and vision as well as team's stakeholders. • Ensures business needs are being met. • Define metrics and monitor them during release
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview

Experiences

Mansi Agrawal
Workex: 24 month
Education Background: BTech in Information Technology

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
Yes, the company had a restriction of having a workex greater than equal to 2 years

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, App Critique

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
Walmart conducts a GD in a group of about 6-7 people per GD. We were given a new product development case where we had to develop an app for senior citizens. Question was open ended no specifications were given

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

In my case there was one only round which went around 1 hour

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

Interview started with a standard question tell me about yourself. Next, they asked me why I wanted to become a PM. Then they asked me about my favorite app and recommendations to improve it. Each recommendation was discussed in detail. Then discussion moved towards the way I will research about the consumer preferences and the way I will present my recommendations in the company

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

I used the resources provided SIGMA and did case discussions with my peers. There was no specific preparation required for Walmart

Piyush Trivedi

Workex: 45 months, product/data analytics
Education Background: Civil Engineer

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

No restrictions were there

PM Topics Covered: Product Design

2. **Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?**

Yes, after prelim shortlisting based on the resume, there was a case-based GD round with around 8 members and 1-2 panelists. The case was a typical app design and development case on EV charging infrastructure service.

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

1 Interview with a single panelist. It was again a case-based interview – to provide a health and wellness solution (app).

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

HR, Resume based & typical PM cases

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

None. Just be aware of the fact that the first step in solving any PM case is to identify problems, and then it becomes a typical marketing case of target segment identification and then the pain-points are solved by specific features. Monetization of features is an impressive skill to show.

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

Just relax and be aware of some apps that you like (specific features about them too) and some apps (or features) that you do not.

Info Edge

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Develop and define product roadmaps and feature concepts • Work with the engineering team to communicate release goals and be a part of product lifecycle. • Interface with Marketing for inputs on consumer marketing activities. • Interface with Sales team to identify product gaps and evangelize new features for products selling. • Understand Customer segments and define product pricing. • Own product performance and conduct periodic performance reviews. • Creative ideation and articulation of ideas. A typical day consists of: • Market Landscaping & Competitive Analysis • Define and Measure Key product Metrics • Develop Go-to-market Strategy
Process	Resume shortlisting + GD + Interview

Experiences

Akshat Singh

Workex: NA
Education Background: B. Tech (CSE)

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
No workex restrictions. No necessity of workex as well.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
There was a group discussion similar to most other GDs.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
There was one interview round. The questions focused mostly on domain knowledge of product management and also involved solving a product improvement case.

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

Questions were focuses mainly on solving a product improvement case. There were also a few resume based questions.

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

Have a brief knowledge of the sectors under Info Edge and the corresponding domain. For preparation, make use of standard PM books like Cracking the PM interview, Decode and Conquer, and other case prep material.

6. **General tips/suggestions?**

Practice enough cases of each variety and have confidence.

Senthil Kumar K

Workex: 36 months
Education Background: NIT Trichy, CSE

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

None. Even a fresher got interned in pm role.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, App Critique, Behavioural, Guesstimates

2. **Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?**

No GD was there

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

Round 1:
Guesstimates, Critic your favorite app/product and suggest changes(approach it like a PM case)
Round 2:
Situation based, why this company, some general HR questions.

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/guesstimates etc.**
   - Not technical or resume based
   - Mainly cases, guesstimates and some HR

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

General PM prep. Read about the company and their products.

6. **General tips/suggestions?**
    - Keep your calm
    - Connect what the company does with your goals.

IBM

Designation	Product Management Intern
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview

Experiences

Manjot Singh

Workex: 34 months, Samsung Electronices
Education Background: CSE , IIT Delhi

1. **Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?**

Yes, workex was required for applying, greater than 24 months

PM Topics Covered: Behavioural

2. **Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?**

No

3. **Interview rounds and their details?**

One interview: with all members (he, director etc) present

4. **What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.**

Three divisions: personal, technical, hr related

- Some on resume, some on personal/professional failure, conflict resolution,etc and how I dealt with them
- One question on how to sell an inventory management system to oil companies. All questions were mainly related to B2B value proposition.
- Other were how will this role help you and some hr related questions around high performance teams

5. **Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?**

Read IBM research papers to get some general idea and it helps in ideatation in interview

Goldman Sachs Marcus

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• Design and build recurring and ad hoc management reports related to credit and fraud risk, compliance, and operational performance and controls • Perform statistical analysis to identify trends and exceptions related to policy execution • Design, build, implement, test and monitor best in class credit decision workflows for digital banking products for top global financial firm. • Collaborate with marketing, analytics, decision science, operation and technology to build a seamless credit decision framework over customer lifecycle that covers targeting, underwriting and servicing of loans. • Analyze and evaluate potential vendors' / data providers for incremental value in credit management strategies in a continuous improvement environment. • Keep up to date with applicable regulations and compliance requirements with possible interactions with internal and external regulators.
Process	Resume shortlisting + Buddy Call + Interview

Experiences

Madhuri Vemulapty

Workex: 22 months, Associate Consultant, Capgemini
Education Background: B.Tech ECE, IIIT Jabalpur

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?
No.

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, App Critique, Metrics, Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
There was on evaluative buddy call.

3. Interview rounds and their details?
- One round of interview. Questions based on resume – projects in work experience and a relevant design project in under graduation.
- Questions about what is my favourite product, why is it my favorite, what I would do to improve it. Asked to design a consumer banking product (Credit Cards), how would I

approach – what are the user segments, pain points, features, and what metrics to measure the success of features.
- Why product management? Why banking sector, why not a tech company?

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.

It was a mix of all questions.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

Resources I've used were Cracking the PM Interview, Decode and Conquer, Sigma PM Prep resources and practiced design questions from the internet.

Atlassian

Designation	Product Management Intern
Job Description	• You'll play a crucial role in one or many areas called out above, while paired with an experienced mentor who will support you in understanding the nuances of Product Management. • You'll get a feel for life as a Product Manager, while also getting a close look into what it's like to be a full-time Product Manager after you have graduated. • You'll also enjoy the opportunity to meet with and network with peer interns and leaders from within the product team and other functions of the company
Process	Resume shortlisting + Case Submission + Interview

Experiences

Adithya M Ramesh

Workex: 24 Months – TCS Digital
Education Background: BTech, Computer science engineering

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

Minimum 24 months required; relevant workex not mandatory, but preferred

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, App Critique, Metrics, Behavioural, Guesstimates

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?

2-page case submission on favourite mobile application, its best/most fav feature, any improvements/new features for that app

3. Interview rounds and their details?

2 interview rounds, 50 minutes each
Round 1 – Mostly focused on product thinking and design sense.
Round 2 – HR, company fit and tech interest round

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.

- Questions in round 1 mostly revolved around case submission and sparring on its feasibility, impact, metrics etc. Few other product design questions were asked. I wasn't asked guesstimates but some of my co-interns were.
- Round 2's questions focused on leadership, ability to work in teams, communication, self-reflection etc. Many questions on current tech trends and their impact on businesses

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?

Good to know about company values, products, and key competitors. Company places huge emphasis on working as a team and being your authentic self, so avoid faking wherever possible.

Corning

Designation	Summer Intern
Job Description	• Market assessment - Analyzing the market trends, display value chain • Developing and supporting various options available to position Gorilla Glass business in India • Understanding the duty structure for display industry
Process	Resume shortlisting + Interview

Experiences

Adil Nazeer

Workex: 3.3 years
Education Background: Mechanical Engineering

1. Were there any workex restrictions? Was relevant workex necessary?

No

PM Topics Covered: Behavioural

2. Were there any pre-processes (GD/case submissions/tests)? If yes details of those?
No

3. Interview rounds and their details?
Only 1 round on interview day

4. What were the kinds of questions focused on? HR/technical/resume based/cases/ guesstimates etc.
HR questions, resume based questions, work related questions such as willingness to work offline vs online organization related questions etc. The role was to conduct Market Research for Gorilla Glass Manufacturing with the expectation that Mobile phone manufacturing is going to boom in India.

5. Resources that you used to prepare and anything specific to the company preparation?
Company website and practice of HR questions

6. General tips/suggestions?
Be prepared with HR questions (Goals, Strengths & Weaknesses, challenges overcome etc.) and an overall view of what the company does, have a genuine conversation and highlight your professional / academic achievements. Take the opportunity to get to know more about the project, its challenges and discuss ideas on how to go about it